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Public Discourse in Conversational Information Consumption: A Linguistic Analysis of Relevant Audio Podcast

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Abstract
This research aims to explore the aspects of conversational dynamics in a selected podcast interview and to analyses how these aspects are realized in the televised podcast featuring conversation between host (Bill Maher) and guest (Elon Musk). The research applies Gail Jefferson's (2004) Conversational Analysis framework to examine features such as Opening Conversation, Turn-Taking, Adjacency Pairs, Repair Mechanism, Preference Organization, Closing Conversation and Feedback. The research method employed is descriptive qualitative and quantitative to uncover how Musk and Maher navigate complex topics such as free speech, artificial intelligence and social polarization. The main data are utterances found in annotated transcript of the podcast while the data source is YouTube interview with a duration of approximately twenty minutes. The results of analysis show that both speakers employ various conversational strategies to maintain conversational control and audience engagement. Bill Maher often initiated topic shifts and uses strategic overlaps to guide the conversation while Elon Musk utilizes pauses, elongated sounds and humor to structure responses and assert his perspectives. These features are realized differently by both participants depending upon their conversational role.

Keywords: Conversation Analysis (CA), Podcast Discourse, Discourse Strategies, Media.

1. Introduction

In contemporary era, podcasts have revolutionized the landscape of digital communication, emerging as a popular and influential medium of discourse blending elements of journalism, entertainment, commentary and public dialogue. Unlike traditional broadcast media that prioritize structured and edited communication, podcasts allow for longer, unscripted and often more candid conversations between speakers where ideas unfold originally and participants engage with one another in real time. This openness has contributed to growing popularity of podcasts, reflecting a shift towards more dialogic and audienceengaged form of knowledge dissemination. As such, the podcast has a become a critical site for analyzing how language functions in public discourse, particularly how meaning is negotiated, how power is exercised and how identities are constructed through talk.

Given this context, the present research seeks to analyses the conversational structure of a podcast featuring Elon Musk and Bill Maher using the lens of Conversation Analysis (CA). Conversational analysis originated in the early 1960's by Schegloff and Jefferson and originally comes from the field of Sociology. Conversation analysis takes part in conversation discourse. With its micro-analytic focus on spoken interaction, Conversational analysis serves as a valuable methodological tool for exploring nuanced structures of communication that occur within the selected podcast interview between Musk and Maher. Rooted in ethnomethodological tradition, Conversational analysis seeks to uncover how participants co-construct dialogues through turn-taking, adjacency pairs, pauses, overlaps and repairs. Gail Jefferson's (2004) transcription system, in particular, provides a foundational tool for mapping out the intricacies of a natural conversation; to analyze how meaning is co-constructed in real-time.

Applying CA to the selected podcast interview reveals how both speakers collaboratively build interaction and navigate topical shifts. Jefferson's model also captures subtle shifts in tone, rhythm and interactional flow making it valuable framework in researching public conversations where speakers are engaged in both personal dialogue and audience- oriented performance.

Brian Paltridge (2012) states that conversation analysis has the sequences and structure. Those sequences are opening conversation, turn-taking, adjacency pairs, preference organization, feedback, repair, and closing conversation. This research tries to find out these sequences that are used in the interview. This research applies Jefferson's Conversation Analysis framework to a selected podcast episode featuring Bill Maher and Elon Musk, two prominent figures in the spheres of media and technology. The choice of selecting this podcast is motivated by the high -profile nature of the participants and the socio-political themes discussed such as free speech, artificial intelligence and political polarization. Their exchange exemplifies a hybrid form of communication where one part is spontaneous conversation and the other is strategic performance designed to resonate with public audience. Through detailed transcription and analysis, this research explores how different conversational features such as overlapping speech laughter, hesitation and timed pauses function within the dialogue to shape meaning, manage alignment and establish conversational authority. As podcasts often occupy a liminal space between private conversation and public performance, Jeffersonian Conversational Analysis enables a finegrained understanding of how speakers modulate their discourse in response to both co - participants and imagined listeners.

The primary aim of this research is to identify and interpret the underlying conversational mechanisms that structure the interaction between Bill Maher, a well-known political commentator and television host, and Elon Musk, a globally

recognized entrepreneur and technology innovator. Rather than focusing on the content of what is said, this research centers on "how" it is said, how conversational roles are established and negotiated. More specifically, the research investigates how features like turn-taking, repair mechanisms and preference organization contribute to the shaping of public personas and ideational authority. For example, how does Bill Maher as a host, guides the conversation and maintains his role as a facilitator while also challenging or humorously undercutting his guest? Conversely, how does Elon Musk manage his responses whether through extended pauses, strategic silences or affiliative laughter to assert intellectual authority or evade confrontation. By examining such interactional strategies through Jefferson's analytical lens, this research contributes to the deeper understanding of a podcast discourse as a layered form of public communication.

1.1. Research Objectives

The main objectives of this research are:

1) To identify the features of conversational dynamics in selected podcast episode.
2) To analyze how these features are realized through turn-taking, pauses, overlaps and other Jeffersonian markers.
3) To understand how these features of conversational strategies used by host and guest contribute to the construction of public discourse.

1.2. Research Questions

Accordingly, the central research questions are:

1) What conversational strategies are employed by the participants in selected podcast?

2) How does these strategies reflect power relations, topic control and speaker alignment?
3) In what ways does Jefferson's framework reveal the structure and function of podcast talk as a public discourse?

1.3. Statement of Problem:

Although podcasts have emerged as a dominant form of digital communication, there remains a significant gap in understanding their micro-level conversational structure, particularly in terms of how meaning is constructed through real-time interactions. Most existing researches in Conversation Analysis (CA) have traditionally focused on face-to-face dialogues, with limited exploration into how such interactions function in a semi-scripted, mediated settings like podcasts. The problem lies in the insufficient application of Jefferson's transcription and analytical model to such contexts, where overlapping speech, pauses, humor and feedback are not merely stylistic devices but serve functional roles in maintaining interactions and guiding audience interpretation. This research seeks to address this gap by offering a detailed analysis of selected podcast episode through the lens of Jeffersonian Conversation Analysis.

1.4. Significance of Research

This research contributes to a broader field of discourse studies by extending application of Conversation Analysis to a digital, media-based interaction. By applying Jefferson's Conversation Analysis framework to a podcast conversation between Elon Musk and Bill Maher, the research explores how interactional features such as opening conversation, closing conversation, turn-taking, adjacency pairs, pauses, overlaps, repair mechanisms and feedback function to construct meaning and shape both speaker's identity and audience's perception. Furthermore, the research demonstrates the relevance and adaptability of

Jefferson's transcription framework in analyzing mediated interactions like podcasts. In doing so, the research extends the scope of Conversation Analysis in analyzing contemporary, digitally mediated interactions that shape a large portion of public communication today.

2. Literature Review:

Conversation Analysis (CA) is a qualitative empirical methodology developed in the 1960s by Harvey Sacks, Emanuel Schegloff and Gail Jefferson. Rooted in ethnomethodological tradition in Sociology, CA initially seemed to uncover the systemic and orderly nature of everyday talk. Its core premise is that conversation is not random but is organized through a series of shared, tacit rules and conventions that participants follow in order to make interaction meaningful (Sacks, Schegloff, & Jefferson, 1974). Jefferson played a pivotal role in refining transcription techniques and elevating the methodological precision of CA.

Through Jefferson's contributions, Conversational Analysis (2004) framework developed into foundational tool not only for understanding conversational structure but also for analyzing interactional dynamics in broadcast and digital contexts. Recent studies have expanded its application to various digital and media contexts, reflecting the evolving nature of communication. For instance, Neumaier (2023) explored how turn-taking mechanisms influence syntactic variations in New Englishes, highlighting the adaptability of Conversation analysis framework in different linguistic settings.

The proliferation of digital media has led researchers to adopt Conversation analysis as a tool to investigate interactional patterns in virtual environments. AlGhizzy and Salih (2023) explored the mechanisms of turn taking and adjacency pair formation within Internet Relay Chat, revealing that asynchronous format often hampers conversational coherence. Likewise, Fatimah et al. (2024) studied turn- taking patterns, repairs, and adjacency pairs in online interactions,

emphasizing the pedagogical implications of conversation analysis in digital learning contexts.

Within podcasts specifically, Untari et al. (2023) conducted a conversation analysis of Jay Shetty Podcast, identifying various conversational features such as interruptions, overlapping dialogues and repair sequences. Their findings reinforce the relevance of CA in analyzing the nuanced dynamics of podcast conversations. Additionally, Saadah et al. (2023) examined turn- taking strategies in English podcasts, highlighting the frequent use of conversational strategies like taking over, promoting and appealing, all of which contribute to effective conversational flow.

Turn-taking continues to be a central focus in Conversation analysis studies. Tabassum and Hafeez (2023) examined how gender influences turn-taking strategies within Pakistani political talk shows. They observed that male speakers frequently used interruptions and overlapping to assert dominance while female politicians generally followed cooperative strategies. This research underscores how conversational structures can reflect and reinforce societal power dynamics. Overlapping speech has garnered significant attention across various media formats. Niapele et al. (2021) examined overlaps in daytime talk shows "The View" categorizing them into collaborative and intrusive types. Their research demonstrates how overlaps can be used as a tool or conversational strategies to express agreement or to assert control over the discourse.

Pauses and silences also play significant role in shaping interactions. In video mediated interactions, latency can disrupt the natural flow of conversation leading to misinterpretation of pauses and increased instances of overlapping talk (Seuren et al., 2021). This research emphasizes the importance of considering technological factors in analyzing conversational dynamics.

Podcast, functioning as hybrid medium that merges elements of traditional broadcasting and informal conversations, opens up possibilities for Conversation Analysis. Dehasan et al. (2023) examined turn-taking patterns in a podcast episode featuring Najwa Shihab and Prabowo Subianto. They identified various interactional strategies such as starting up, promoting and overlapping. Their research illustrates how podcast speakers navigate conventional roles and manage discourse flow within this semi-structured format.

Although research in Conversation Analysis has frequently documented turn-taking and repair mechanisms in face-to-face interactions, but the podcast discourse, particularly at the intersection of private dialogue and public performance, remains unexplored. Studies have not yet thoroughly explored how micro-level conversational aspects such as elongated syllables, laughter, timed pauses and intonation patterns in podcasts interviews serve to construct and negotiate power dynamics, ideological positions and speaker's credibility. This research aims to address these gaps offering a detailed, Jeffersonian Conversation Analysis of a selected podcast episode featuring Bill Maher and Elon Musk. By doing so, it aims to contribute to the growing body of literature on digital conversation and to demonstrate the continued implication of Conversation Analysis in analyzing mediated, public discourse in digital age.

3. Methodology

This research is grounded in the theoretical framework of Conversation Analysis drawing specifically on Gail Jefferson's (2004) model for transcribing and examining interactions. Jefferson's approach emphasizes a fine-grained analysis of spoken discourse particularly turn-taking, repair, and overlapping talk making it well-suited for the micro- analysis of podcast conversations.

The conversation between Bill Maher and Elon Musk has been examined through both qualitative and quantitative content analysis methodologies. To

facilitate a thorough analysis, the podcast was transcribed using online resources to create an accurate written record. Furthermore, transcription conventions introduced by Gail Jefferson (2004) have been manually incorporated to enhance the depth of the analysis. Subsequently, the conversation was scrutinized to identify the conversational elements as outlined by Paltridge: Opening Conversation, Turn-taking, Adjacency Pairs, Repair Mechanism, Preference Organization, Closing Conversation, and Feedback.

Thirdly, a category and coding scheme is developed. Drawing upon the structural format of Lilis Uli Artha Nababan. et al (2023) in their research "A Conversation Analysis on The Interview Between Ellen Degeneres And Hillary Clinton", the utterances which have been identified are then coded into specified classifications of aspects of conversational interactions to ensure clarity and cohesion. For instance; Opening Conversation was coded OP, Adjacency Pairs was coded AP, Preference Organization was coded PO, Turn Taking was coded TT, Feedback was coded F, Repair was coded R, and Closing Conversation was coded CC. Fourth, coding all texts. The data are numbered and differentiated between the interviewer and interviewee by giving the IR and IE codes, and data and descriptive quotations are displayed in the conversation. Lastly, after coding all the texts, the conclusions were drawn to answer the research questions.

4. Data Analysis:

This section provides a detailed analysis of the conversational data collected for the research, through the methodological framework of Conversational Analysis. By examining the Opening Conversation, Turn-Taking, Adjacency Pair, Repair Mechanisms, Preference Organization, Closing Conversation and Feedback, this analysis reveals how speakers collaboratively manage interactional roles, shape meaning and sustain communicative order within various contexts. The discussion integrates findings with relevant theoretical insights to interpret the

structural and functional aspects of the observed podcast conversation. The following table presents the frequency of all seven elements used in the verbal discourse of the podcast.

Table 1: Frequency of conversational interaction elements

No.	Aspects of Conversational Interactions	∑
1.	OC	1
2.	TT	119
3.	AP	54
4.	R	10
5.	PO	54
6.	F	75
7.	CC	1

4.1. Opening Conversation

Opening conversation sets the grounding to proceed with dialogue in a particular manner, therefore it is the most significant element of conversation analysis. It refers to the initial exchange of dialogue that includes greetings, an introduction of the participants, and the topic of discussion. It is usually informal, polite, and short utterances. According to Schegloff (1986), opening conversation is crucial to setting the tone and direction of conversation.

In the podcast of Maher, the opening conversation is observed as composite: a critical topic with a humorous and sarcastic tone. Maher introduces his guest, Musk, and presents a greeting. However, his manner of opening the conversation via acknowledgement of past programs foreshadows the discussion on his multiple projects. The transcript of conversation has been given below:

"Bill Mehar: My first guest is the man who made electric cars a thing and is currently working on perfecting reusable rockets, space travel, connecting the human brain directly to computers, connecting cities with electromagnetic bullet trains, the Star link satellite

system that's so important to the war in Ukraine, and then on Tuesday(.). NOW LAUGHTER (.)he's going to work on that tunnel thing on traffic. He also tweets a lot. Elon Musk, ladies and gentlemen."

These opening utterances with a lighter tone, along with the audience's welcoming and cheering response, bring the guest at ease immediately. The list of achievements presents the guest as an influential personality; meanwhile, the witty approach sets the stage for an engaging and insightful discussion. Maher instantly shifts the situation towards the dialogue effectively by asking simple questions and offering a turn to Musk.

"NOW CHEERING Look at you. ↑Wow. Did I get the full order of things that you do in a day there? When I was reading there, I left out the tunnel thing at the end. Do you work on all these.?

Elon Musk: = A lot of jobs."

These initial lines of conversation reflect a smooth transition from introduction to interaction.

Later, dialogue is observed taking a conversation style, as Maher offers his assumptions and presents pleasure while Musk suggests enlightening perspectives. An early touch of humor continues throughout the conversation, keeping audiences engaged in the discussion. Thus, a blend of formal and informal opening conversation successfully shapes the host-guest dynamic in a critical discussion and captures the attention of audiences throughout the remainder of the dialogue.

4.2. Turn-taking

In conversational analysis, Turn-taking is an important aspect of maintaining a

smooth transition in a dialogue. Turn-taking is a process in which participants speak alternatively, giving each other equal opportunity to speak and listen. According to the model of Sacks, Schegloff, and Jefferson (1974), "The basic rule in English conversation is that one person speaks at a time, after which they may nominate another speaker, or another speaker may take up the turn without being nominated."(Paltrige 95).

In the selected podcast, the conversation advocates a strong Turn-taking system, exhibiting the quality of interview-style interaction. The host, Bill Maher, usually starts the conversation by asking questions and presenting his views. Meanwhile, the guest, Elon Musk, elaborates his ideas and responses. An excerpt from the transcript of the podcast illustrates a natural progression in a dialogue.

"Maher: Do you do all these things every day? Do you work on all of them in a single day?
Musk: No: (....)"

Similarly, in some instances, transitions also occurred through 'latching' indicated by "=" in the transcript where the guest responds instantly as the speaker finishes. It is often intended to bring humor and sarcasm during interaction. To illustrate, here is an excerpt from the transcript:

"Maher: Yeah(.). OK. So, you are one of these dealers, these people who deal with the cards.
=
Musk: = I deal with some memes, too. NOW Laughter"

It reflects a connected and engaging dialogue.

Furthermore, the conversation also exhibits the instances where one speaker takes the opportunity to assert his view while the other speaker takes a pause. As it can be observed in the provided example from the transcript of conversation between Mehar and Musk:

"Maher: Okay, so this(.).

Musk: I really can't emphasize this enough. We must(.) we must protect free speech. And free speech only matters(.). It's only relevant when it's someone you don't like saying something you don't like, because obviously the speech that you like is, you know, it's easy.

So, it's(.). And it's(.). The thing about censorship is that, for those who would advocate it, just remember, at some point, that will be turned on you. NOW applause"

It reflects Musk's attempt to seize the opportunity and takes turn diplomatically. Another example highlights polite turn-taking as:

"Maher: OK. Let's talk about A.I. You were on this tip ten years ago when nobody else was. I always thought, he's right. Why? Because I've seen too many movies. Everything that happens in movies happens in real life. NOW Laughter If you make things that are way smarter than you, why wouldn't they become your overlords? What did you say to Chuck Schumer? What are we doing about this? I know you want a pause in A.I. Just in the last six months with ChatGPT, which came from a company you started.

Musk: Yes. NOW LAUGHTER A friend of mine has a modification of Occam's razor. Instead of the simplest thing being the most likely, the most ironic outcome is the most likely. NOW Laughter

Maher: Right. =

Musk: = Yes. With respect to A.I., I just think we should umm::, have some sort of regulatory oversight.

For anything that is a danger to the public, if it's aircraft, cars, food and drug and whatnot, we've got some regulatory oversight, like a referee, essentially, and making sure that companies don't cut corners. Um:: I think that since(.) If one agrees that A.I. is a potential risk to the public, then there should be some regulatory body that oversees what companies are doing so that they don't cut corners and potentially do something very dangerous. NOW APPLAUSE"

Additionally, a frequency count of transitions by both participants presents a complete summary of Turn-taking throughout the conversation.

Table 2: Turn-Taking Distribution Between Host and Guest

No.	Speakers	Turn Taking	%

1.	H	60	50.42
2.	G	59	49.58
	Total	119	100

This data chart shows that the host took 60 turns, and the guest took 59 turns. There is a minimal gap between the host's and the guest's Turn-taking opportunities. This almost equal contribution by participants reflects the interactive environment of the interview. However, a modest increase in the host's participation is indicative of the podcast format, where the host holds the power to initiate and guide the conversation. However, the guest, Musk, also holds a significant number of turns, often delivering long utterances, indicating a free space for him to provide input to the discussion. Thus, Turn-taking ensures a coherent shift and uninterrupted verbal interplay.

4.3. Adjacency pairs

Another significant aspect of meaningful communication is adjacency pairs. These pairs denote the two subsequent verbal expressions delivered by two individual speakers as a reaction to one another. Paltridge, a renowned scholar in discourse analysis defined Adjacency pairs as these are "utterances produced by two successive speakers in a way that the second utterance is identified as related to the first one as an expected follow-up to that utterance."(97) Adjacency pairs have various forms following the context of discourse, including greetinggreeting pair, question-answer pair, request-acceptance, compliment-acceptance, and agreement-disagreement. These adjacency pairs act as "fundamental units" in discourse organizations and "keys" to how the information is delivered and interpreted.

The conversation between Maher and Musk is largely structured by adjacency pairs. The prominent pair in this dialogue is a question-answer pair, aligning with

the standard pattern of interview-style interaction. Maher initiates the conversation with a question, which is subsequently answered by Musk. An example from the transcript presents a simple question statement followed by respective responses in a linear way.

> ***"Maher: Do you do all these things every day? Do you work on all of them in a single day? Musk: No:"***

Similarly, another notable adjacency pair found in this conversation is assertionagreement. Maher often offers his view, whether it is a part of the formal discussion or that Musk evaluates and affirms.

> ***"Maher: I feel like, very often, wokeness is not building on liberalism. It's the opposite of liberalism. = Musk: = Yes, exactly."***

This excerpt from the transcript highlights the mutual understanding and shared knowledge of both participants, structuring the dialogue effectively. However, such pairs are also used as a tactic to bring humor and light-mode sarcasm into the discussion. As quoted from the dialogue:

> ***"Maher: = I mean, they attack you a lot. Musk: They do."***

Another instance reflects the adjacency pair of compliment-acceptance as

> ***"Maher: Well, you(.). Well, you're a likeable guy.***
> ***Musk: Thanks."***

Yet, several other adjacency pairs in the conversation are condensed into frequency figures showcased in the chart.

Table 3: Frequency of Adjacency Pair Types

No.	Adjacency Pair Type	Frequency	%
1.	Question - Answer	12	22.22

2.	Assertion - Agreement	10	18.52
3.	Assessment - Agreement	3	5.55
4.	Assertion - Confirmation	3	5.55
5.	Compliment - Acceptance	2	3.70
6.	Assertion - Acknowledgement	2	3.70
7.	Assertion - Disagreement	2	3.70
8.	Other (20 different types)	20	37.04
	Total Pairs Identified	54	100

The dominant number of question-answer pairs manifests the conventional hostguest interaction. Overall, various types of adjacency pairs shape a collaborative tone.

These excerpts reveal the role of adjacency pairs in making communication coherent and mutual, chronologically conveying knowledge.

4.4. Repair Mechanism

Repair Mechanism is a significant element in maintaining meaningful communication. Repair Mechanism refers to how the speaker takes initiative towards the problems in speaking, hearing, and understanding during the conversation. There are several types of repair mechanisms, such as self-initiated self-repair, where the speaker him/herself corrects his/her speech. Additionally, it can be others-initiated self-repair that refers to the situation when a listener makes the speaker repair by asking questions or hinting at the problem.

In the conversation between Maher and Musk, there are frequent moments of repair mechanisms, as both the host and the guest evaluate and accentuate the complex ideas about technology and their viewpoints. These mechanisms clarify

the meaning and intention, resolve slips of the tongue, and offer a spectrum of outlooks.

One of the most prominent self-initiated self-repairs instance is as follows:

"Musk: Let me give you an example that a friend of mine told me, which, you know, his daughters go to college in(.). Sorry, go to high school in the Bay Area."

In this line, it is clear that Musk cuts himself at "...go to college in," takes a short pause, and rectifies the location.

In another instance,

"Musk: So, uh:: (.)(.). You know, another way to(.). Almost synonymous would be cancel culture."

It helps to follow the maxim of quality and manner during the speech, making it successful.

Similarly, this conversation is also guided by others-initiated self-repair as Maher often questions to help Musk make a precise claim.

"Musk: = No::, no::, resources will be fine.
Maher: But they're not fine.
Musk: Look, I'm not suggesting complacency.
Musk: Earth is 70% water by surface area.
Maher: But you can't drink that.
Musk: Desalination is absurdly cheap."

These lines highlight the useful impact of repair mechanisms to avoid ambiguity and miscommunication, preserving accurate interpretation. However, a frequency chart of repair mechanisms during the whole dialogue is presented below:

Table 4: Frequency of Repair Mechanism Types

No.	Repair Type	Count

1.	Self-Initiated Self-Repair by Host	1
2.	Self-Initiated Self-Repair by Guest	6
3.	Other-Initiated Self-Repair (Host Initiates, Guest Performs)	3
	Total Repair Instances	10

This frequency count indicates a slight edge in the guest part, illustrating a natural trait of unscripted dialogue where the speaker navigates the complex thoughts and revises the utterances. It reflects a spontaneous and complex verbal outplay. Meanwhile, others-initiated self-repair is crucial to uphold the conversation mutually.

4.5. Preference Organization

Preference organization, in conversation analysis, refers to the tendency towards a specific form of response, preferred or dispreferred, to structure the discourse of conversation. Preferred responses, such as agreements and acceptances, are usually prompt and instant. Meanwhile, dispreferred responses, including disagreements and refusals, are often delayed and accompanied by explanations. However, dispreferred responses do not cause miscommunication or disruption but are managed by politeness and respect.

In conversation analysis of the selected podcast, a hybrid preference organization is observed. In question-answer adjacency pair, direct and prompt responses are prominent. For instance:

"Maher: Do you do all these things every day? Do you work on all of them in a single day? Musk: No:."

Similarly, in terms of agreement and disagreement, Musk seems to show agreement on Maher's assessment. He gives a spontaneous affirmative reaction. It reflects co-constructive opinions, favoring a preferred organization of the talk. For instance:

> ***"Maher: [...]I feel like, very often, wokeness is not building on liberalism. It's the opposite of liberalism. =***
>
> ***Musk: = Yes, exactly."***

However, dispreferred responses are often hesitated but regulated with strategies to avoid disrespect and face threats. For example:

> ***"Musk: Yeah(.). Exactly. It's like(.). You know, the(.). You know, slavery is obviously a horrific institution, but we should still know more about George Washington than that.***
> ***Maher: And by the way, one that was practiced all over the world forever, since the beginning of time, by every race, including people of color. I'm sorry to tell you that. It's huge in the Bible.***
> ***"Musk: Absolutely. =***
> ***Maher: = The Bible loves it. NOW Laughter***
> ***Musk: We're(.). They're quite strict about, like, you know, don't take someone else's slave and that kind of thing. =***
> ***Maher: = Right, but no::-one ever says, just don't do it."***

In the podcast, it is observed how Maher and Musk shows disagreement to each other's opinion tactfully often through satirical approach. It maintains a productive communicative discourse. Additionally, it underscores the significance of valuing counterpart's beliefs instead of adopting aggressive stance. A keen observation of frequency count reveals a general trend of preferred responses in this conversation, displayed in the tabular form below:

Table 5: Preference Organization Count

No.	Preference	Count
1.	Preferred Response	41
2.	Dispreferred Response	13
	Total	54

The higher frequency of preferred responses highlights a clear inclination towards accord responses. However, both the participants navigate preferences skillfully, structuring a nuanced discourse of the podcast.

4.6. Feedback

Another crucial aspect of conversation analysis is feedback that facilitates the continuation of the conversation. Feedback refers to those responses that indicate the clarity of understanding or the reaction, such as agreement and disagreement, to the speaker's utterances. Feedback can be composed of short responses such as "ok, yes, and yeah" and can be an elaborate remark on the speaker's assertion. Feedback is a vital tool to reinforce a collaborative and interactive approach towards communication. It enables logical transition, demonstrating turn-taking and equal participation.

In the selected podcast, feedback is clearly evident throughout dialogue in various forms. In terms of acknowledgement, there are many instances where short responses reflect active participation and comprehension. Maher often makes a statement followed by affirmative responses from Musk. An excerpt from the transcript supports the claim as:

"Maher: Many times?
Musk: Yeah(.), =
Maher: = I mean(.). Every week?
Musk: Yeah(.). =

Maher: = From left and right. I've had it from both sides.

Musk: Yeah(.).

Maher: And it's interesting, people(.) You and I are both, like, in that little group of people. Maybe it's a bigger group now.

Musk: Yeah(.).”

Furthermore, Maher also provides Cooperative replies to Musk's statement, continuing the conversation. He effectively follows Musk's claims, evaluates them and articulates either agreement or disagreement. It helps to balance the two-way dynamic communication. For instance:

“Musk: Earth is 70% water by surface area.

Maher: But you can't drink that.

Musk: Desalination is absurdly cheap.

Maher: Why don't we do it, then? You have a lot of free time. NOW Laughter”

It reflects an argumentative and lively discussion rather than a monologue. Moreover, feedback from audiences is also observed in this conversation analysis. The explicit reaction of listeners in the form of "applause and laughter". It adds another layer to the success of communicative discourse. Hence, this multilayered feedback system plays a role in building a cohesive, fluid and captivating podcast atmosphere.

4.7. Closing Conversation

In conversation analysis, closing conversation refers to the act of bringing the discussion to an end. It is often comprised of gratitude and polite greetings. According to Schegloff and Sacks (1973), the closing conversation is not an abrupt ending but follows a sequence of utterances that signals, both the guest and the audience, the completion of the discussion (quoted paltridge,2012). Similar to opening a conversation, the host holds the power to terminate the discussion

politely and respectfully. The closing conversation of the selected podcast follows the conventional style of discussion closure presented by Schegloff and Sack (1973).

Maher, the host of the podcast, manages the termination of the discussion. His language and particular phrases hint at the ending of the dialogue as he says:

"Maher: ... Look, I could talk to you forever, we can't today."

This line predicts the end of the conversation effectively due to the constraints of time. Additionally, the structure of the closing conversation is reciprocal to the opening conversation: politeness and short talks. It adds to the symmetry and cohesion of the discourse. Similarly, in the selected podcast, Maher expresses his gratitude and appreciation for Musk: a significant part of the closing conversation of an interactive and collaborative interaction. For example:

"Maher: But you seem to handle that OK. I hope you do. Um:: Look, geniuses are going to be a little quirky sometimes, but your heart is always in the right place. You were trying to fix this world. Look, I could talk to you forever, we can't today. I'd love to get high with you, I know a great place to do that. NOW Laughter and Applause
But I can't tell you how much I appreciate you. I know you have a lot of choices and places you can go.
Thank you, Elon Musk, ladies and gentlemen. All right, I'll see you soon, Elon."

These utterances, hence, reflect a natural and deliberate closing strategy on the part of both speakers. It results in an expected end, ensuring a warm and polite exit aligning with the overall discourse of the podcast environment.

5. Conclusion

This research has unveiled the intricate aspects of verbal discourse through the lens of Gail Jefferson's framework of conversation analysis. The close examination of a selected podcast conversation between Bill Maher and Elon

Musk highlights the defining features of opening Conversation, Turn-taking, Adjacency Pairs, Repair Mechanism, Preference Organization, and Closing Conversation of a talk. The frequency count of Turn-taking, Adjacency Pairs, Repair Mechanism and Preference Organization highlights a cooperative conversation between the host and the guest rather than the dominance of a particular speaker. The host is observed as the one initiating a conversation and hands over the turn to the Guest, Elon Musk, who affirms, mitigates and expresses disagreement. Thus, the research reflects how both speakers uphold the decorum of meaningful conversation, employing a strategical approach. The hybrid structure, formal and informal, of the podcast offers a rich understanding of the real-time situation.

By addressing the technical topic through the infusion of humour, aspects of conversation analysis assist in constructing a scholarly discourse. Ultimately, conversation analysis highlights the role of aspects of conversation in discourse building, revealing how speakers use these elements to create interactive two-way communication and manage power relations among speakers.

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